

3.1 The Ribbon

The Ribbon, or the “Microsoft Office Fluent User Interface”, can give you quite the culture shock the first time you use it, but it makes PowerPoint’s features much easier to access. The old menu is gone, and the File menu has been replaced by the Office button. There’s also the Quick Access Toolbar, which contains commonly used functions like Save, Undo, and Redo.



This is all that still remains a bit familiar

3.1.1 The Home Tab

When you start PowerPoint 2007, you’ll see that the Home Tab in the Ribbon shows you all the basic features you need to start creating your presentation—create a new slide, format text, some basic work with objects, and so on—not too unlike the default toolbar set you get when you first start up PowerPoint 2003.



The Home Tab tries to keep you in your comfort zone

It may look like some of the dialog boxes you’re used to have gone, but that’s not so. For example, if you use the Office Clipboard a lot (it lets you copy and paste multiple text items, unlike the Windows clipboard), you can access the Clipboard Pane by clicking the little button at the corner of the Clipboard region of the Home Tab (see screenshot).